

Court No. - 29

Case :- CRIMINAL MISC. WRIT PETITION No. - 15724 of 2014

Petitioner :- Smt. Leelawati Sharma And Another

Respondent :- State Of U.P. Thru Secy. And 2 Others

Counsel for Petitioner :- S.P. Verma

Counsel for Respondent :- Govt. Advocate

Hon'ble V.K. Shukla, J.

Hon'ble Shashi Kant, J.

Heard learned counsel for the petitioners, learned AGA for the State.

Petitioners have approached this Court with a request to quash the FIR dated 26.08.2014 registered as Case Crime No. 240 of 2014 under Section 135 of the Electricity Act, at police station-Faizganj Baheta, district-Budaun.

This Court has the occasion to peruse the FIR and the FIR in question does disclose a cognizable offence, in view of this, there is no occasion for this Court to quash the FIR, as has been prayed on behalf of petitioners, as such, prayer made on the said score is refused by this Court.

Learned counsel for the petitioners contended that the offence in question, as has been alleged to have been committed by the petitioners is under Section 135 of the Electricity Act and for the same even if the charges are found to be proved sentence of more than 7 years cannot be awarded and, in view of this, mechanically arrest should not be effectuated by the police personnel. Learned counsel for the petitioners next contended that the offence in question, as has been alleged to have been committed by the petitioners, is compoundable also.

The fact of the matter is that till date arrest has not been effectuated and this is mere apprehension of the petitioners that they would be arrested in breach of provisions as contained under Section 41 (1) (b) read with Section 41-A of the Cr.P.C. Once there is statutory provision provided for then it is always expected that the said provisions would be adhered to and in case there is any violation of the same, complaint can also be made before the Magistrate concerned to remedy the situation and if petitioners' offence is compoundable, they may seek their remedy as provided under the provisions of Electricity Supply Code, 2005.

In view of the above, it is hereby directed that in case arrest of petitioners is to be effectuated and the offence, in which they are wanted, will not entail sentence of more than 7 years then in that event concerned police personnel should deal with the matter in compliance of the provisions as contained under Section 41 (1) (b) read with Section 41-A of the Cr.P.C.

Writ petition stands disposed of.

Order Date :- 9.9.2014/YK